ARTIST TALK:

A HARMONIOUS SYSTEM?

ALICE IN EXILE

Kahra Scott-James
Victoria University,
Melbourne

ABSTRACT

Alice in Exile combines words, beats and noise in reflection of what appears to be a post-digital delusion surrounding technology, creativity and defiance.

The end of World War II left poets questioning mainstream politics and culture. Kerouac is said to have coined the term "beat generation" to describe the down-and-out status of himself and peers during those post-war years. Defying social conformity, mainstream conventions, and literary tradition was central to their work.

In 1981 Laurie Anderson's part-spoken, part-sung O Superman unexpectedly rose to Number 2 on the UK Singles Chart. Anderson claims the inspiration for the work was the crash of a military rescue helicopter during Iran hostage crisis of1 979-1980. Later that year she played pub circuits with William Burroughs and John Giorno. By the mid-1980/s Anderson debated whether there was much of an Avant-garde scene left to comment on anything.

Girltalk (2002-2014) produces mashups of unauthorized samples from other artist’s songs. The New York Times Magazine (2008) has called these releases "a lawsuit waiting to happen". The name Girl Talk was chosen to stir things up, and embarrass overly serious borderline academic type electronic musicians. While mashups are nothing, what is music if it has nothing to say?

http://aliceinexile.bandcamp.com